Supplement Table 6: Findings of studies examining the association between occupational sitting and Body Mass Index (BMI) and obesity[1]

Nr.	Study	Sample	Major occupational groups	Length of follow-up/ duration	Assessment of occupational sitting (as analysed)	Outcomes[2]	Findings[3]	Study quality[4]	Sex-stratified analysis
	First author, year, country, cohort	n (%female) age at baseline	General population or specification		Categories of measurement and standardized instrument (if applicable)	(Data basis)	Statistical results and reference categories (e.g. risk estimates with 95 % confidence interval)	(++) (+) (0)	Yes/no
1.	Eriksen2015 Denmark DWECS	n=3482 (51.8 % F); 18–59 y	Working population	(2005–2010)	Change in self-reported sitting time (h/wk) between 2005 and 2010 in 5 categoriesas: large decrease (<-7.5), moderate decrease (=-7.5 to <-2.5), no change (=-2.5 to 2.5), moderate increase (>2.5 to 7.5), large increase (>7.5)	BMI change (self-reported)	Reference: large increase in sitting time M large decrease: ΔBMI=0.04 (-0.22–0.31) F large decrease: ΔBMI=-0.43 (-0.77– -0.10) **Positive association between changes in sitting time and BMI in women, but not in men.**	+	Yes
2.	Lin 2015 USA National Longitudinal Survey of youth 1979 (NLSY79)	n=5285 (46.7 % F); 38–45 y	20 different occupations general population (incl. working)	(2002–2010)	Job exposure matrix: self-reported job information used to extract time spent sitting at work from O*NET database by occupation	BMI (self-reported)	All longer sitting time: β=0.054 (p<0.05) M longer sitting time: β=0.086 (p<0.01) F longer sitting time: β=0.025 (p=0) **Longer sitting time was significantly associated with higher BMI for the overall sample.** **For men, the association was significant; for women, the coefficient of sitting time was not statistically different from zero.**	+	Yes
3.	Picavet 2016 Netherlands Doetinchem Cohort Study	n=1509 (% F not reported); 20–60 y	Paid employment and self-employed, general population (incl. working)	(1987–2010) 15 y	Self-reported OPA in 4 categories as sedentary work, mainly standing, manual, or high physical loads at 5 time points, categorized into stable sitters (sedentary at least at 3 out of 5 measurements) and non stable sitters at work	BMI and obesity (objective/measured)	Reference stable non sitting at work stable sitting at work: OR=-0.25 (-0.68–0.19) BMI (kg/m²) **Stable sitting at work was not associated with BMI.**	+	No
4.	Pinto Pereira 2013 Great Britain 1958 British Birth Cohort	n=6562 (49.4 % F); 45–50 y	General population (incl. working)	5 y	EPIC-Norfolk physical activity questionnaire: self-reported work sitting time in h/wk categorized into 6 levels: 0 h/d; 0–1 h/d; 1–2 h/d; 2–3 h/d; 3–4 h/d; >4 h/d	BMI and BMI change (objective/measured and self-reported)	Reference 0–1 h/d work sitting (Mean=0) 1–2 h/d: -0.13 (-0.64–0.37) 2–3 h/d: 0.40 (-0.07–0.87) 3–4 h/d: 0.16 (-0.24–0.55) >4 h/d at 50 y: 0.16 (-0.24–0.55) **No linear trend for work sitting with 45 y or 50 y BMI, or for BMI change.** 45–50 y change 2–3 h/d work sitting: Mean=0.33 (0.10–0.56) **Those sitting 2–3 h/d had greater BMI gain by 0.33 kg/m² (0.10–0.56) compared to those sitting 0–1 h/d.**	+	No
5.	Pulsford 2013 Great Britain Whitehall II cohort study	n=1971 (25 % F); mean age 40.5 y	Clerical and office support, executive, senior administra-tive grades only working population	(1997–2004)	Self-reported work sitting time/wk, summed up into 4 categories	Incident obesity BMI >30 (objective/measured)	Reference 0–20 h/wk (OR=1) 21–30 h/wk: OR=0.87 (0.43–1.75) 31–39 h/wk: OR=0.85 (0.44–1.62) >40 h/wk: OR=1.10 (0.59–1.96) **Work sitting time not associated with incident obesity.**	+	No
6.	Saidj 2015 Denmark Health 2006 cohort	n=1403 (54 % F); 18–69 y; mean age: 44 y	General population (incl. working)	(2006–2011) 5 y	Physical Activity Scale 2 (PAS2), assessing self-reported time spent in daily sedentary work (h/d)	BMI (objective/measured)	5 y BMI change/work sitting time (h/d): Risk estimate β=-0.02 (-0.06–0.02) **No association between baseline work sitting time and 5y BMI change. No sex interaction was found.**	+	No

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	First author, year, country, cohort	n (%female) age at baseline	General population or specification		Categories of measurement and standardized instrument (if applicable)	(Data basis)	Statistical results and reference categories (e.g. risk estimates with 95 % confidence interval)	(++) (+) (0)	Yes/no
7.	Thompson 2017 USA	n=228 (100 % F); 19–61 y ca: mean age: 36.8 y; ac: mean age: 40.7 y	Health care/clinic: appoint-ment coordina-tors (ac) or clinical assistants (ca)	Average 6.9 y	Women's Health Initiative (WHI) Physical Activity Questionnaire; Self-reported job as ac with 90 % workday sitting or ca with in median 25 % workday sitting	Weight change (anual rate of change in BMI) (medical records)	Job with in median 90 % of work time sitting (ac) was associated with 0.15 increase in BMI/y (0.4 kg/y)[4] more than 25 % work sitting in median (ca) in F. **Predominantly sitting occupation borderline significantly associated with weight change (BMI increase/year)[5] compared to standing/walking occupation.**	+	Fermales only
8.	Martin 2013 Great Britain 1946 British Birth Cohort	n=3035 (51.5 % F); 53 y	Different occupations general population (incl. working)	Not reported	Job exposure matrix: Self-reported occupation, assigned to 5 categories of OPA, with one of them sitting >2 h/d, summed upinto 3 categories: sitting unlikely, somewhat likely, highly likely	BMI (standar dised protocol)	Persons in non-manual occupations had a higher BMI than those in manual occupations, small and inconsistent associations between BMI and occupational activities[5]. No evidence for associations with exposure to occupational sitting with BMI in men or women.	0	Yes

Legend:
BMI: Body Mass Index
h/d: hours per day
n (% F): number of participants (percent female)
OPA: occupational physical activity
1 In alphabetical order and after methodological assessment rating (high to low quality)
2 In model adjusted for age, sex, leisure time physical activity (LPTA), health behaviour (alcohol, smoking, diet), and socioeconomic status (education, household income) if available, unless reported otherwise
3 Methodological Assessment incl. risk of bias: assessment after the SIGN-checklists resulting in overall ratings of 'high quality' (++), 'acceptable quality' (+) and 'unacceptable/low quality' (0), synonymic with 'high quality' (++) / low risk of bias, 'acceptable quality' (+) / accepable risk of bias, and 'unacceptable/low quality' (0) / unacceptable risk of bias.
4 Not adjusted for socioeconomic status
5 Not adjusted for LPTA